F3 BUILDING SURVEYORS

BUILDING SURVEY REPORT

The Co-Proprietors per Trinity Factors

55 Caledonian Crescent, James Square, Edinburgh
Project Number: 21049
Date: 30-Nov-21
Revision: Not applicable

F3 BUILDING SURVEYORS
99 Giles Street, Edinburgh EH6 6BZ
0131 554 8050 | **f3surveyors.com**

55 CALEDONIAN CRESCENT, JAMES SQUARE, EDINBURGH

BUILDING SURVEY REPORT

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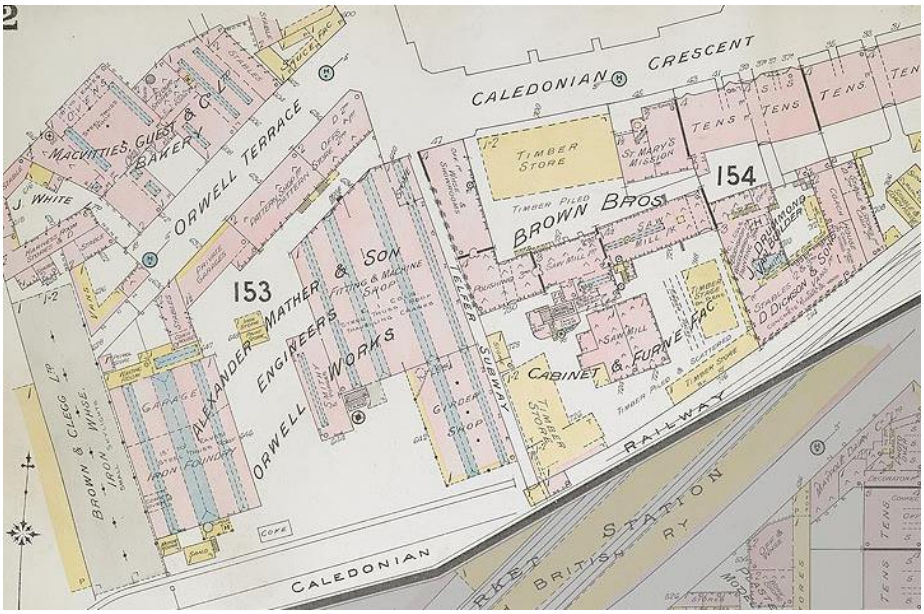
This report has been prepared by F3 Building Surveyors Limited with all reasonable skill, care and diligence, within the terms of the Contract with the Client. The report is confidential to the Client and F3 Building Surveyors Limited accepts no responsibility of whatever nature to third parties to whom this report may be made known.

1. INTRODUCTION

1.1. On behalf of The Co-Proprietors per Trinity Factors, we were requested to undertake a building fabric survey to the roof area of the property comprising 55 Caledonian Crescent, part of the James Square development, Edinburgh.

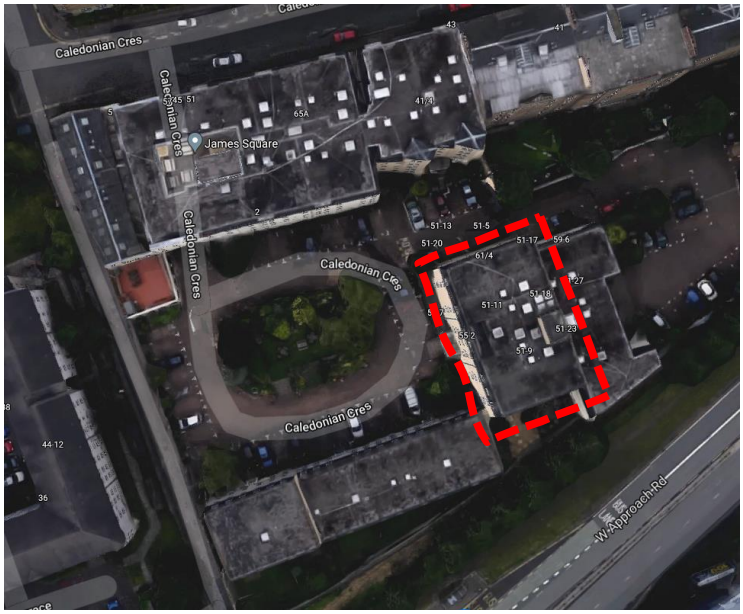
1.2. We undertook our survey on 14th October, this was undertaken by David Bonar, MRICS, Chartered Building Surveyor and Sally Orr, MRICS, Chartered Building Surveyor, with access provided by onsite co-ordinator.

1.3. The property comprises a flatted residential block within a larger development, the block in question is over five floors. Our understanding is that the properties are on the site of a former timber store and sawmill / furniture works (see map below). The property is not a listed building and neither is it within a Conservation Area.



1.4. The property appears to be traditionally constructed with a wet dash wall finish, slated mansard sections at the top floor and the roof is of a flat roof construction.

1.5. The property is located on Caledonian Crescent, Edinburgh.



1. INTRODUCTION (cont)

1.6. We were given access to the following areas:

1.6.1. External fabric: Please refer to separate report and costs in relation to the elevations.

1.6.2. Roof coverings: We were able to undertake an inspection via access from a ladder from the roof of 39 adjacent up onto the roof. There is no access from the common stair to the roof covering to roof 55. We also undertook a high level survey with the cherry picker to the elevations, at this time, where accessible we undertook an inspection of the slated mansard roof area as well as the balcony. We would note that we have included any repair costs to the balcony within the elevations report rather than within this roofing report.

1.6.3. External curtilage: Not applicable for the purpose of our survey.

1.6.4. Internally: Not applicable for the purpose of our survey.

1.7. Areas of no access: We were unable to fully access the south most elevations due to the trees as well as the layout of the block.

1.8. For the purposes of the report, the front elevation is assumed to face west. All references to left hand side and right hand side are taken when viewing the relevant elevation from external facing the building.

1.9. We were not provided with any Health and Safety file nor the Operation & Maintenance Manual for the building. We have not been provided with any information for example builders estimates or the like.

1.10. Please note that this report is not intended for issue to contractors for pricing works. In the event that the owners decide to proceed with the works we would strongly recommend that full and comprehensive tender documentation be prepared, we can undertake this if required.

2. GENERAL OBSERVATIONS

2.1. The building is generally in a fair condition however the roof covering requires some repair:

2.1.1. Flat roof: The roof comprises a main flat roof, with a plant room (which we assume was intended for a lift motor room, however, has not been used as that as there is no lift present). The flat roof comprises a mineralised felt finish, we have assumed that this has been overlaid at some point in the recent past. We were advised, there has been issues with water ingress and ponding, and there has been a remedial detail with a felt covered batten which has been added to direct water away from the balcony to the front elevation. We would note that the roof appears to have been fairly recently replaced and there is likely to be a guarantee in place for the works. There appears to be a general issue in relation to the fall of the roof as it appears to be from front to rear and thereafter side to side, the fall does not appear to be shedding water as it should. The roof appears to have been insulated at the time of feltwork.

2.1.2. Detailing: We noted to the roof lights, the upstand appears to be fairly low in that it is 100mm rather than the expected 150mm. The roof lights are generally in a fair condition. Detailing around the 4nr roof lights towards the west most of the roof adjacent to the louvered panels, has a very minimal gap between them and the upstand, there have been repairs carried out with a liquid plastic / acrypol product to a basic standard however would appear to be functioning. We have included for works in the medium term.

2.1.3. To the plant room roof there are louvered timbers, these timbers now require paintwork in the short term. The feltwork roof to the plant room appears in a fair condition.

2.1.4. Copes: There are open joints to the perimeter copes as well as the detailing at the feltwork which is open, these are potential areas of water ingress and we have allowed for repairs in the short term.

Photo 01 – General view of the roof

Photo 02 – Installed detail to shed water away at front.

Photo 03 – Narrow gap between roof lights and upstand.

Photo 04 – Feltwork open at upstands, and open joints to copes.

2. GENERAL OBSERVATIONS (cont)

Photo 05 – Louvres requiring repairs and painterwork.

Photo 06 – Slatework requiring repairs, and leadwork requiring to be re-fixed.

2.1.5. Mansard slated sections: Repairs are required in the short term to the mansard sections, and we have allowed a short term sum for re-fixing of broken and missing slates. We have also included for a tidy up / replacement of a section of the perimeter flashing to the flat roof at the front elevation where it is loose / damaged.

2.1.6. Guttering: We would allow for the guttering to be cleared out in the short term.

2.1.7. Balcony: The balcony to the top floor flat to the front elevation has had repairs carried out in the past, we have referred to this within our elevations report where we have allowed for short term repairs including a re-covering of the balcony deck and re-mastic to the shiplap cladding. The leadwork has recently been renewed to this section and generally it is in a good condition.

3. RECOMMENDED WORKS

3.1. Our recommendations would be to undertake the repairs as required to the following areas:

RED PRIORITY: IMMEDIATE / SHORT TERM (YEARS 1-2):

3.2. In terms of immediate / short term actions we would recommend the following:

3.2.1. Check the guarantee with the regard to the roof replacement and thereafter refer to poor upstand detailing to the perimeter, see photographs above for contractor to return and undertake works. We would also suggest that confirmation is sought with regard to the falls to the roof area as these appear to be creating ponding areas.

3.2.2. Asbestos: We have included for an asbestos refurbishment survey prior to any works.

3.2.3. Copes: Point up existing concrete copes.

3.2.4. Painterwork and timber repairs: We have included for painterwork and timber repairs to the plant house louvers and timberwork to same.

3.2.5. Guttering: Allow for clear out of existing guttering.

3.2.6. Slated mansard sections and associated leadwork: Allow for replacement of slipped and broken slates as well as missing, and repairs to the platform edge leadwork.

AMBER PRIORITY: MEDIUM TERM (YEARS 3-5):

3.3. In terms of medium term actions, we would recommend the following:

3.3.1. Assuming the works are carried out in the short term, there should be limited works required in the medium term with the exception of annual inspection and gutter clearing.

GREEN PRIORITY: LONGER TERM (YEARS 6-10):

3.4. In terms of longer term actions, we would recommend the following:

3.4.1. We would assume that the roof may be becoming to the end of its guarantee period, we would advise that annual inspections should be carried out to advise further in the future with regard to replacement of the flat roof. It would be anticipated to be towards the end of the 10 year period therefore we have not included for any flat roof replacement at this time.

4. CONCLUSION

4.1. In conclusion, based on our survey, repairs are required in the short term to the roof, and also in the medium term.

4.2. We refer you to our budget costs which highlight the short and medium term repairs required.

4.3. If you wish our further input or assistance in this regard, we would be delighted to do so.

4.4. We thank you for asking us to assist.

Prepared by F3 Building Surveyors Ltd.
30-Nov-21

Prepared by:	**SO**	Date:
Checked by:	**RS**	**3-Dec-21**

APPENDIX 1 – BUDGET COSTS

Description	Quantity	Units	Rate	Total	RED: Short Term	AMBER: Medium Term	GREEN: Longer Term
55 James Square Roof							
SUPERSTRUCTURE							
Roof							
Roof coverings							
Flat Roof							
Short Term - Minor repairs at upstands etc.	1	Item	750	750.00	750.00		
Short Term - Copes, point up joints	1	Days	300	300.00	300.00		
Short Term - Dowel Fix Copes	16	No	100	1,600.00	1,600.00		
Short Term - Plant room roof, timber repairs and painterwork.	1	Item	750	750.00	750.00		
Slated Mansard							
Short Term - Replace slipped, broken, missing slates.	1	Item	2000	2,000.00	2,000.00		
Leadwork - Replace / refix slipped perimeter flashing.	1	Item	500	500.00	500.00		
Roof drainage							
Guttering							
Short Term - Clear out of existing and repairs.	1	Item	750	750.00	750.00		
Roof lights							
Medium Term - Repairs to detailing to tightly spaced roof lights.	1	Item	250	250.00		250.00	
PRELIMINARIES							
Facilitating Works							
Toxic / Hazardous / Contaminated Material Treatment							
Toxic / Hazardous Material Removal							
Asbestos Refurbishment Survey	1	Item	500	500.00	500.00		
Main Contractor's Preliminaries							
Scaffolding / Work at height							
Scaffolding Short Term							
To all Elevations to facilitate slatework and repairs to flat roof and guttering.	1	Item	15000	15,000.00	15,000.00		
Crash Deck internally	14	No	150	2,100.00	2,100.00		
Access Medium Term for Roof Light Repairs - assume access from ladder and rope access.	1	Days	1000	1,000.00		1,000.00	
Management and General Preliminaries							
Short Term	4	wks	600	2,400.00	2,400.00		
SUB-TOTAL CONSTRUCTION COSTS				**27,900.00**	**26,650.00**	**1,250.00**	**0.00**
VAT			**20%**	**5,580.00**	**5,330.00**	**250.00**	**0.00**
TOTAL INCLUDING VAT				**33,480.00**	**31,980.00**	**1,500.00**	**0.00**

NOTES

1. No fees included as only minor works required.

APPENDIX 2 – STANDARD CONDITIONS

Content of the Report

In accordance with these terms the Surveyor will use his or her best endeavours to report upon:

a. The main aspects of the Property including assessing the site/location, the design, structural framework, fabric and services;

b. The grounds, boundaries and environmental aspects considered to affect the Property;

c. Any requirements for further investigation arising from the inspection.

Assumptions

Unless otherwise expressly agreed the Surveyor while preparing the Report will reasonably assume that:

a. The Building(s) (if for sale) is offered with vacant possession;

b. The Building(s) is connected to mains services with appropriate rights on a basis that is known and acceptable to the Client; and

c. Access to the Building(s) is as of right upon terms known and acceptable to the Client.

Scope of the inspection

A. Generally

a. The Surveyor will consider his or her advice carefully but is not required to advise on any matter the significance of which in relation to the Building(s) is not apparent at the time of inspection from the inspection itself.

b. The Surveyor will inspect diligently but is not required to undertake any action that would risk damage to the Building(s) or injury to himself, herself or any other party.

c. The Surveyor will not undertake any structural or other calculations.

d. The Surveyor will not produce a repair schedule, planned maintenance report, feasibility report or advise on design, procurement or project management unless expressly agreed with the client.

B. Accessibility

a. The Surveyor will inspect as much of the internal and external surface area of the building as is practicable but will not inspect those areas which are covered, unexposed or not reasonably accessible from within the site, or adjacent public areas.

b. The Surveyor is not required to move any obstruction to inspection including, but not limited to, fixtures, fittings and floor coverings.

c. The surveyor will not open up or cut into the building fabric without specific directions from the client. Such intrusive investigations, if instructed by the client, will be at the risk and liability of the client and will be assumed to be with agreement between the client and the building owner.

C. Floors

a. The Surveyor will lift accessible sample loose floorboards and trap doors, if any, which are not covered by heavy furniture, ply or hardboard, fitted carpets or other fixed floor coverings. The Surveyor will not attempt to cut or lift fixed floorboards or other floor fabric without the express permission of the owner.

D. Fixed covers or housings

a. The Surveyor will not attempt to remove securely fixed covers or housings without the express permission of the owner.

E. Roofs

a. The Surveyor will inspect the roof spaces if there is a safe working platform available to work from. Where no safe working platform or access is available, the roof spaces will not be inspected. Similarly, outer surfaces of the roof or adjacent areas will be inspected using binoculars, but will be excluded if they cannot be seen.

F. Boundaries, grounds and outbuildings

a. Where reasonable access is available the inspection will include boundaries, grounds and permanent outbuildings but will not include temporary buildings or structures.

G. Services

a. The Surveyor will carry out a visual inspection of the service installations where reasonably accessible. Drainage inspection covers will be lifted where they are reasonably accessible and it is safe and practicable to do so. No tests of the service installations will be carried out unless previously agreed, although general overall comments will be made where reasonably possible and practicable. The Surveyor will report if it is considered that tests are advisable. Specialist inspection of electrical installations or gas mains will not be undertaken.

H. Areas not inspected

a. The Surveyor will identify any areas which would normally be inspected but which he or she was unable to reasonably inspect.

I. Environmental and other issues

a. Particular noise, dust, flooding or contaminated land and disturbance affecting the Property will only be noted if it is reasonably significant at the time of the inspection or if specific investigation has been agreed between the Surveyor and the Client and confirmed in writing.

b. The Surveyor will report on any reasonably obvious health and safety hazards to the extent that they are apparent from elements of the Property considered as part of the inspection.

c. The Surveyor will not undertake a fire risk assessment or consider fire safety risks to the extent that they are apparent from elements of the property considered as part of the inspection.

J. Hazardous materials

a. Unless otherwise expressly stated in the Report, the Surveyor will assume that no deleterious or hazardous materials or techniques have been used in the construction of the Property. However, the Surveyor will advise in the Report if, in his or her view, there is a likelihood that deleterious material has been used in the construction and specific enquiries should then be made or tests carried out by a specialist.

b. Subject to section B to page 1, the Surveyor, based upon a limited visual inspection, will note and advise upon the presence of lead water supply pipes and asbestos.

c. The Surveyor will advise in the Report if, to the best of his or her knowledge, the Property is in an area where, based on information published by the National Radiological Protection Board, there is a risk of radon. In such cases the Surveyor may advise that tests should be carried out to establish the radon level.

d. The Surveyor will endeavour to advise if there are transformer stations or overhead power lines which might give rise to an electromagnetic field, either over the subject Property or visible immediately adjacent to the Property. The Surveyor is not required to assess any possible effect on health or to report on any underground cables.

K. Ground conditions

a. The Surveyor will not be required to comment upon the possible existence of noxious substances, landfill or mineral extraction implications, or other forms of contamination, nor will the Surveyor advise on the adequacy of the substratum for any particular purpose unless geotechnical tests or specialist advice are commissioned by the client.

L. Consents, approvals and searches

a. The Surveyor will be entitled to assume that the Building or site is not subject to any unusual or onerous restrictions, obligations or covenants which apply to the Property or affect the reasonable enjoyment of the Property.

b. The Surveyor will be entitled to assume that all planning, Building Regulations and other consents required in relation to the Property have been obtained. The Surveyor will not verify whether such consents have been obtained. Any enquiries should be made by the Client or the Client's legal advisers. Drawings and specifications will not be inspected by the Surveyor unless otherwise previously agreed.

c. The Surveyor will be entitled to assume that the Property is unaffected by any matters which would be revealed by a Local Search and replies to the usual enquiries, or by a Statutory Notice, and that neither the Property, nor its condition, its use or its intended use, is or will be unlawful.

M. Exclusions

a. We have not inspected woodwork or other parts of the structure which are covered, unexposed or inaccessible and we are therefore unable to report that any such part of the property is free from defect.

b. We must stress that we have not carried out any investigation to determine whether any high alumina cement was used during the construction of the building inspected and we are therefore unable to report that the building is free from risk in this respect. In view of the possible potential danger connected with high alumina cement we strongly recommend that the appropriate investigations, inspections and tests be carried out immediately by a suitably qualified engineer.